A350

COLD & DARK TO LANDING

FLIGHT-TEST EDITION / VERSION 1.0

A complete, flight-independent procedure for learning the iniBuilds Airbus A350 in Microsoft Flight Simulator 2024. Includes OIS, SimBrief, FMS, performance, engine start, taxi, takeoff, cruise, ILS approach and landing.

CONTENTS

How to use this guide

01 - Flight planning and preparation

02 - Cold and dark: electrical power

03 - OIS: SimBrief, fuel and payload

04 - FMS initialisation and company route

05 - FMS departure, arrival and route check

06 - Takeoff performance and FCU

07 - Cockpit and overhead checks

08 - Pushback and engine start

09 - Taxi and before takeoff

10 - Takeoff and initial climb

11 - Climb and cruise

12 - Arrival and landing performance

13 - ILS setup and intercept

14 - Final approach and landing

15 - Quick reference: phase gates

16 - Troubleshooting checkpoints

17 - Flight test notes and corrections

How to use this guide

Version 1.0 - flight-test edition. iniBuilds Airbus A350 in Microsoft Flight Simulator 2024.
This is a generic simulator walkthrough, not an aircraft operating manual. Use your current SimBrief OFP, published charts, current weather, and the in-sim checklist. Record corrections on the final pages.

- Load the aircraft at a parking stand with cold-and-dark state selected.
- Keep the SimBrief OFP and departure/arrival charts accessible.
- Use the CHECK and VERIFY lines as hold points before moving to the next stage.
- Runways, speeds, weights and thrust settings always come from the current flight; do not copy values from a different flight.
- When a step differs in your installed aircraft version, note what the screen actually shows rather than guessing.

01 - Flight planning and preparation

Goal: prepare a valid OFP and know the route, loading, constraints and weather before powering the cockpit.

> 01. Generate or retrieve an OFP in SimBrief for the correct A350 variant.

> 02. Note FROM, TO, ALTN, callsign, registration, route, cruise altitude and cost index.

> 03. Note ZFW, block fuel, planned taxi fuel, trip fuel, alternate fuel and final reserve.

> 04. Check planned runway, SID, STAR, transition and approach against current charts and weather.

> 05. Confirm the aircraft is at the intended parking stand; set/verify parking brake.

> VERIFY: The OFP is current, the aircraft profile is correct, and all flight-dependent figures are identified.

02 - Cold and dark: electrical power

Goal: make the displays available and start navigation alignment. The A350 overhead has two main batteries and two emergency batteries.

- 01. Confirm parking brake SET; engine masters OFF; engine start selector NORM.
- 02. On ELEC overhead select BAT 1 ON.
- 03. Select BAT EMER 1 ON and BAT EMER 2 ON.
- 04. Select BAT 2 ON.
- 05. Request ground services/power where available; select EXT 1 and/or EXT 2 when AVAIL.
- 06. Confirm electrical power indications and powered displays.
- 07. Set all three ADIRS rotary selectors to NAV; allow the alignment to complete.
- 08. Check for any relevant ECAM or navigation accuracy messages before continuing.
- VERIFY: Electrical supply established; displays powered; ADIRS alignment correct; no unexplained warnings.

03 - OIS: SimBrief, fuel and payload

Goal: retrieve the OFP and apply the actual aircraft loading. OIS import and FMS company-route request are separate steps.

> 01. On the OIS open FLT OPS MENU.
> 02. If required, open OPTIONS > 3RD PARTY and verify the numeric SimBrief User ID.
> 03. Open FLT OPS STS and select SIMBRIEF IMPORT.
> 04. Check the returned origin, destination and flight identifiers.
> 05. Open LOADSHEET; compare ZFW and fuel with the OFP.
> 06. Use SET ZFW and SET FUEL as appropriate to load the aircraft.
> 07. Recheck actual aircraft loading; do not assume the OFP itself physically loaded fuel.
> VERIFY: Correct SimBrief flight shown; aircraft ZFW and fuel match the intended plan.

04 - FMS initialisation and company route

Goal: transfer the SimBrief route to the MFD/FMS and confirm that it is active.

> 01. Open FMS MFD ACTIVE / INIT.

> 02. Verify navigation database and initialisation state.

> 03. Select CPNY F-PLN REQUEST and wait for a response.

> 04. Reopen ACTIVE / INIT and confirm FROM, TO, ALTN, CPNY RTE, FLT NO, CRZ FL and CI.

> 05. Open ACTIVE / F-PLN to check route legs have populated.

> 06. If a request remains pending or the route is empty, do not treat it as successfully imported.

> VERIFY: Company route imported; initialisation values match the current OFP.

05 - FMS departure, arrival and route check

Goal: select runway/procedures and activate only reviewed temporary changes.

> 01. From FMS flight-plan pages open DEPARTURE.

> 02. Choose the assigned/planned runway, then the applicable SID and transition.

> 03. Review TMPY departure legs; compare the path and restrictions with the chart.

> 04. Press INSERT TMPY to activate the reviewed departure.

> 05. Open destination ARRIVAL; select runway, approach, STAR, VIA and transition as appropriate.

> 06. Review the TMPY arrival and approach data; INSERT TMPY only after verifying.

> 07. In F-PLN/PLAN view inspect every leg from departure to destination.

> 08. Investigate route discontinuities; do not delete them automatically.

> 09. If requesting winds, confirm the uplink succeeds; a pending request is not confirmation.

> VERIFY: Correct active departure and arrival; no unexpected gaps or restrictions; route matches OFP.

06 - Takeoff performance and FCU

Goal: calculate flight-specific speeds/thrust and ensure correct initial guidance.

- 01. In the OIS open T.O PERF.
- 02. Synchronise available route, runway, weight and weather details as supported.
- 03. Check runway length/condition, wind, QNH, temperature, takeoff mass, anti-ice and flap setting.
- 04. Select COMPUTE or the appropriate calculation control for your aircraft version.
- 05. Review resulting V1, VR, V2, FLEX/TOGA and takeoff configuration.
- 06. Transfer performance to FMS using SEND TO FMGS or equivalent.
- 07. Check takeoff performance is present on the FMS.
- 08. Set departure QNH and the initial cleared/published FCU altitude.
- 09. Confirm flight directors, lateral mode and the FMA armed/active guidance.
- VERIFY: Takeoff values were computed for current conditions and confirmed on the FMS.

07 - Cockpit and overhead checks

Goal: complete normal pre-start configuration without assuming a generic switch position is correct for every flight.

> 01. Review ECAM status and any outstanding messages.
> 02. Check aircraft electrical, fuel, air/bleed, hydraulic and anti-ice configurations.
> 03. Confirm ADIRS alignment complete and navigation status normal.
> 04. Check oxygen, signs and exterior lighting for the current phase.
> 05. Confirm flight control indications and FMS/FCU values as appropriate.
> 06. Brief the departure, runway, initial altitude, thrust and rejected-takeoff plan.
> 07. Complete the applicable cockpit preparation/before-start checklist.
> VERIFY: No unexplained indications; aircraft is ready for pushback and engine start.

08 - Pushback and engine start

Goal: secure the stand, provide a suitable start source and verify both engines have started normally.

> 01. On OIS GROUND, close required doors and remove/disconnect equipment when appropriate.
> 02. Confirm APU or other approved electrical/pneumatic start source is available.
> 03. Switch beacon ON before starting engines.
> 04. Set surveillance/transponder controls as required.
> 05. Obtain pushback/start clearance if operating with ATC.
> 06. Begin pushback. Maintain parking brake/tug coordination per the ground service used.
> 07. Follow the aircraft start checklist: select IGN/START as required and start engines in the specified order.
> 08. Observe engine parameters until each start is confirmed; check ECAM for abnormalities.
> 09. Return engine start selector to NORM and complete the after-start flow.
> 10. Ensure the tug is disconnected and ground area clear before taxiing.
> VERIFY: Both engines stable; no start faults; after-start checklist completed.

09 - Taxi and before takeoff

Goal: configure the flight controls and aircraft for the departure runway.

> 01. Confirm taxi clearance, ground-service disconnection and correct taxi route.
> 02. Perform a flight-control check and observe the expected indication.
> 03. Set flaps to the calculated takeoff setting; arm spoilers when appropriate.
> 04. Set rejected-takeoff autobrake mode as required.
> 05. Run T.O CONFIG and review takeoff memo; resolve relevant warnings.
> 06. Taxi at a controlled speed, using the airport navigation map if available.
> 07. At the holding point recheck runway/SID, initial altitude, V-speeds and thrust setting.
> 08. Complete the before-takeoff checklist and configure exterior lights.
> VERIFY: Takeoff memo satisfied; flight controls, flap setting, route and speeds correct.

10 - Takeoff and initial climb

Goal: take off using calculated thrust and monitor the actual FMA modes.

> 01. Confirm runway identification and applicable ATC clearance.
> 02. Align with runway centreline and apply the calculated FLEX or TOGA thrust.
> 03. Confirm engine response, speed indications and FMA takeoff modes.
> 04. Maintain directional control. At VR rotate smoothly.
> 05. Confirm positive climb and retract landing gear.
> 06. Follow flight-director commands; engage AP when appropriate.
> 07. Monitor thrust reduction and acceleration prompts; retract flaps within speed limits.
> 08. Check the FMA after every major autopilot or FCU input.
> VERIFY: Correct lateral/vertical guidance, climb path, flap retraction and thrust mode.

11 - Climb and cruise

Goal: monitor the aircraft and prepare the arrival early enough to avoid rushing.

> 01. Comply with cleared altitude and published SID constraints.
> 02. Verify autopilot lateral and vertical modes on the FMA.
> 03. Compare fuel, route progress and arrival estimate with the OFP.
> 04. Observe speed/altitude restrictions through climb.
> 05. Obtain destination weather, expected runway and the current approach chart.
> 06. Review the STAR, approach, minima and missed approach before top of descent.
> VERIFY: Route progressing correctly; fuel appropriate; approach plan understood.

12 - Arrival and landing performance

Goal: configure the destination approach and calculate landing data for current conditions.

> 01. Check destination ATIS/weather and any ATC assigned approach.
> 02. In FMS ARRIVAL verify runway, STAR, VIA, transition and approach.
> 03. Review TMPY changes and use INSERT TMPY only after checking.
> 04. Inspect route continuity and all altitude/speed constraints.
> 05. Open OIS LDG PERF and verify landing mass, runway, condition and winds.
> 06. Calculate landing performance and note the expected VAPP and landing configuration.
> 07. Brief approach minima, runway exit and missed-approach plan.
> VERIFY: Arrival and landing plan match weather, charts and any ATC clearance.

13 - ILS setup and intercept

Goal: establish correct ILS guidance before descending on the glideslope.

> 01. Confirm the ILS approach is entered in the FMS and active route.

> 02. On the FMS PERF APPR page enter/verify QNH, temperature, wind, VAPP, minima and landing configuration as applicable.

> 03. On RAD NAV, verify the ILS identifier, frequency and inbound course against the chart.

> 04. Select LS to display localiser and glideslope deviation information on the PFD.

> 05. Follow the arrival/intercept clearance; be at the published intercept altitude, usually below the glideslope.

> 06. Activate approach phase if not already active and if required by the aircraft mode.

> 07. Press FCU APPR at an appropriate intercept position; monitor the FMA.

> 08. Check LOC and G/S are armed \(blue\), then capture \(LOC* / G/S*\) and track \(LOC / G/S in green\).

> 09. If only localiser captures, check altitude/path and glideslope validity; do not assume G/S capture.

> VERIFY: Correct ILS tuned, both lateral and vertical guidance confirmed on FMA, safe intercept path.

14 - Final approach and landing

Goal: become stabilised, complete the landing checklist and either land or go around.

> 01. Monitor lateral and vertical path, speed and altitude on the PFD.

> 02. Extend flaps progressively within their indicated speed limits.

> 03. Select landing gear DOWN and final landing configuration at the appropriate point.

> 04. Verify approach speed, landing checklist, gear and landing indications.

> 05. Check the FMA: LOC and G/S tracking; if planning autoland, verify suitable runway/aircraft capability and required AP configuration.

> 06. For a manual landing, disconnect AP at a suitable point and maintain the intended flight path.

> 07. Maintain a stabilised approach. If unstable or guidance is unreliable, go around.

> 08. At touchdown monitor spoilers/deceleration; use reverse thrust and brakes appropriately.

> 09. Vacate the runway when safe and perform the after-landing checklist.

> VERIFY: Landing complete, deceleration controlled, runway vacated safely.

15 - Quick reference: phase gates

Use this sheet at each transition; it is a memory aid, not a substitute for the in-sim checklist.

- [ ] OFP/aircraft version and current weather confirmed
- [ ] Batteries, power and ADIRS established
- [ ] OIS SimBrief import and actual fuel/payload checked
- [ ] Company F-PLN, SID, STAR, approach and discontinuities reviewed
- [ ] Takeoff performance computed, transferred and verified
- [ ] Before-start and engine-start checks complete
- [ ] T.O CONFIG and before-takeoff checklist complete
- [ ] FMA guidance checked after takeoff and in climb
- [ ] Arrival and landing performance reviewed
- [ ] ILS frequency/course, LS indication, LOC and G/S capture checked
- [ ] Gear/flaps, VAPP, stabilised approach and landing checks complete

16 - Troubleshooting checkpoints

Use these prompts to diagnose symptoms observed in the cockpit.

- FMS route missing: check numeric SimBrief ID, current OFP and CPNY F-PLN REQUEST status.
- Arrival/departure still yellow: confirm the TMPY revision was reviewed and INSERT TMPY completed.
- DISCONTINUITY: review chart/procedure before altering; some gaps are intentional.
- Takeoff speeds missing: check OIS loadsheet, computed takeoff data and SEND TO FMGS transfer.
- FMA differs from expected mode: check managed/selected guidance rather than relying on FCU selection alone.
- No G/S capture: check the ILS tune, intercept position/altitude and APPR arming.
- DEST EFOB BELOW MIN: compare predicted arrival fuel with FMS minimum and OFP reserve/alternate; reducing the threshold does not add fuel.
- Navigation warning: check ADIRS/alignment and applicable system indications; do not ignore abnormal indications.

17 - Flight test notes and corrections

Fill in after your next test flight so the next edition matches your installed iniBuilds A350.

- Aircraft version/build: _____
- SimBrief route: _____
- Departure / runway / SID: _____
- Arrival / runway / STAR / ILS: _____
- Steps that matched the simulator: _____
- Steps that differed or were missing: _____
- Exact FMA indications during ILS intercept: _____
- Unexpected warnings and when they appeared: _____
- Screenshot/video timestamps for revision: _____
- Additional notes: _____
- _____
- _____